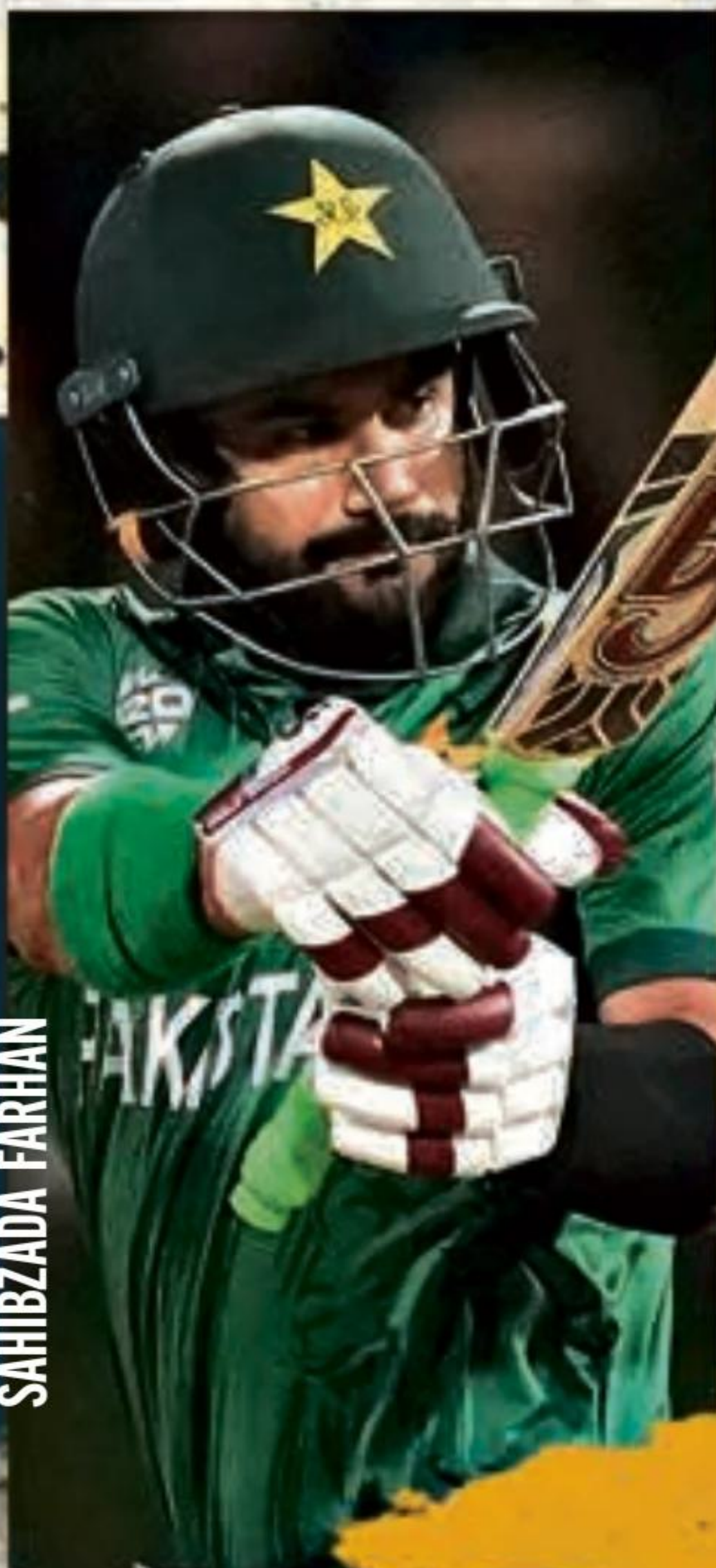




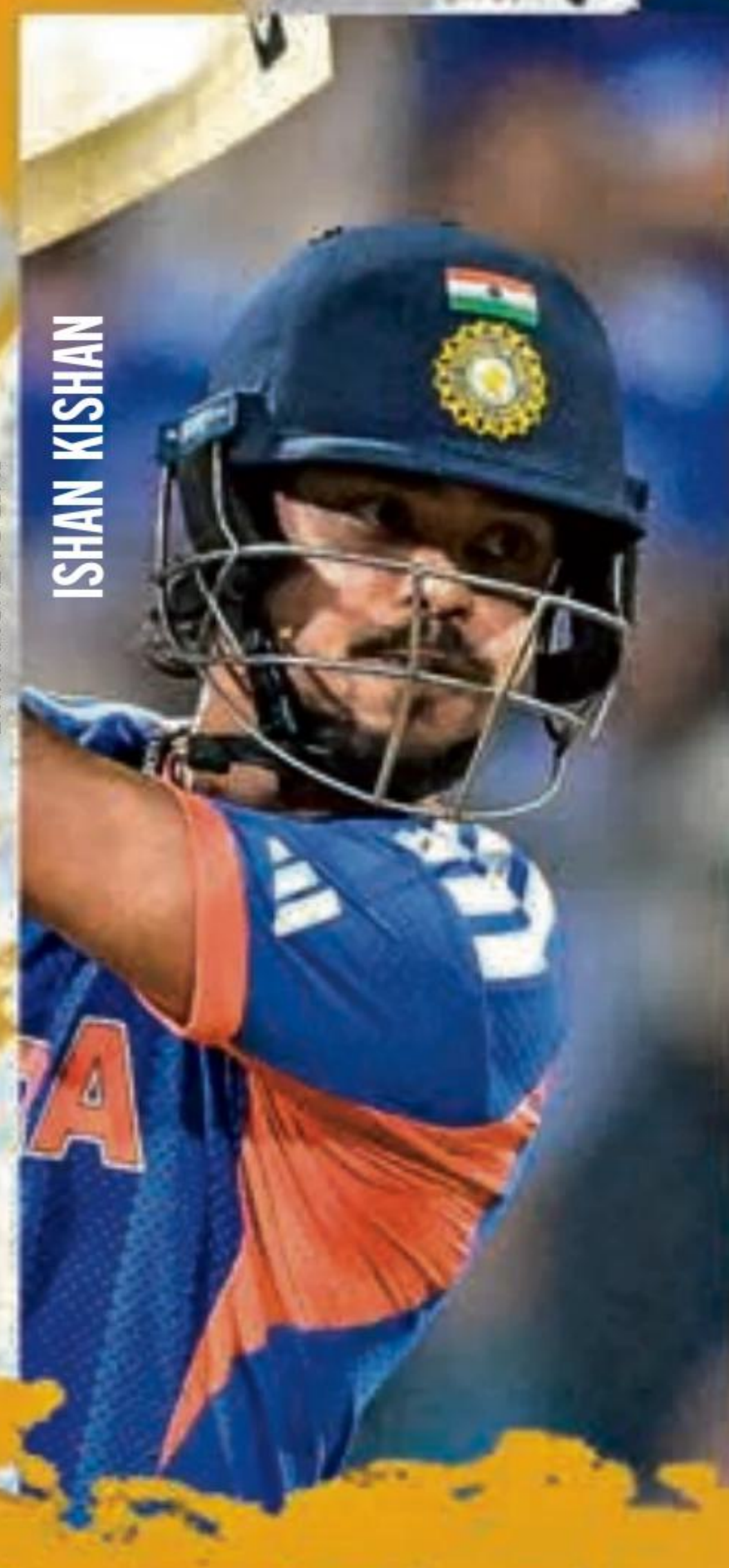
SANJU SAMSON

EMMANUAL YOGINI



SAHIBZADA FARHAN

AP



ISHAN KISHAN

EMMANUAL YOGINI

THE CHOSEN

Sanju Samson arrived late but left the deepest imprint on India's run to a second successive T20 World Cup title. Recalled after a lean run, Samson responded with three defining innings in succession. An unbeaten 97 against West Indies steered India through a tense chase of 196 in the Super Eights decider. He then struck 89 in the semifinal against England to power India to 251, which it defended by seven runs. Another fluent 89 followed in the final against New Zealand, helping India pile up a record 255 for five. Samson collected Player of the Match awards in the first two games and ended the tournament with the Player of the Tournament honour, scoring 321 runs from five innings, the third-highest tally overall.

Innings - 5, Runs - 321, Highest - 97 not out, Average - 80.25, Strike Rate - 199.37, 50s - 3, 4s - 27, 6s - 24

Pakistan opener Sahibzada Farhan finished as the highest run-scorer of the tournament, amassing 383 runs in six innings, including two centuries – 100 not out against Namibia and 100 against Sri Lanka. Farhan not only gave Pakistan brisk starts but also steered the innings through the middle overs to anchor the batting effort. While his unbeaten century overwhelmed Namibia, his hundred against Sri Lanka helped Pakistan clinch the game by five runs, though the team could not qualify for the semifinals due to its poor Net Run Rate.

Innings - 6, Runs - 383, Highest - 100 not out, Average - 76.60, Strike Rate - 160.25, 100s - 2, 50s - 2, 4s - 37, 6s - 18

Ishan Kishan lived up to his 'pocket dynamo' tag with a blistering campaign, scoring 317 runs in nine innings at an average of 35.22 and a strike rate of 193.29. He began the tournament as an opener before shifting to No. 3 after Sanju Samson returned to India's playing XI, adapting seamlessly to the role. Kishan ensured India rarely lost early momentum, striking at 178.12 in the PowerPlay before lifting his scoring rate even higher as the innings progressed. His 77 off 40 balls on a testing pitch at Colombo's R. Premadasa Stadium proved decisive in India's clash with Pakistan, where the next best score was 44 by Usman Khan. He saved one of his sharpest bursts for the final, smashing 54 off 25 balls to propel India to 255 for five against New Zealand in Ahmedabad, the highest total ever recorded by a team in a knockout in T20Is.

Innings - 9, Runs - 317, Highest - 77, Average - 35.22, Strike Rate - 193.29, 50s - 3, 4s - 33, 6s - 18